Coast Life Constructions — Instagram Profile Audit

Audited 6 July 2026 · Managed by 10x Visuals
Benchmarked against: @barlowbuilding, @grimmondau

Executive summary — what's actually going on

Coast Life Constructions has the **on-site raw material** (real projects, real team, real trade network) but the account currently reads as a **tradie mate's page**, not a builder homeowners hire for a $1M+ custom build. The audience commenting is roofers and pumpies — not architects, designers, or homeowners.

The **fastest path from where they are to where Barlow is** is not more content — it's a positioning shift: name the projects, show the design intent, elevate the caption voice, and add finished-build hero shots to the mix.

This document is the reason for every choice in the rebuilt `brand_voice.md`, `strategy_guide.md`, `bio.md`, and `pinned_posts.md`.

Where Coast Life sits today

Handle: @coast_life_constructions_qld
Location: Varsity Lakes, QLD 4227 (Gold Coast)
Website: coastlifeconstructions.com.au

Recent posts (last 30 days)

Date	Format	Caption	Likes	Comments
~3 Jul 2026	Carousel	"Long days and steady work. That's what goes into every build we take on."	34	4
25 Jun 2026	Carousel	"On the tools again today. Gear on site and the boys getting straight into it."	23	0
5 Jun 2026	Carousel	"The first half of the year has been a busy one. A huge credit to the Coast Life team..."	12	0
19 Mar 2026	Reel	"Concrete going down and the structure starting to take shape at our Ladds Ridge project."	14	1

What's working ✅

- **Consistent identity as a hands-on Gold Coast builder** — the trade authenticity is real and rare.
- **Drone aerials are strong** — high production value moments in an otherwise ground-level grid.
- **Comment community is engaged** — @r.g_roofing, @lukethepumpy, @harry_south_roofin_co all real trade suppliers, real relationships.
- **Named a project once** ("Ladds Ridge" — 19 March). This is the format that needs to become the norm, not the exception.

What's broken ❌

- **No finished build hero shots.** Every visible post is BTS or process. A homeowner researching builders will scroll for 30 seconds and see zero completed homes. That's a critical gap.
- **Captions are all interchangeable.** "Long days and steady work" / "On the tools again today" / "Getting straight into it" — swap any of these onto another builder's account and no one would notice. There's no design story, no material specifics, no reason for a homeowner to save the post.
- **Trade-mate audience, not client audience.** Comments are roofers ribbing team members. That's not a bad thing — it's proof of relationships — but if the account is meant to drive $600k+ enquiries, the commenter mix is wrong.
- **Cadence gap 19 Mar → 5 Jun.** ~11-week silence. Algorithm penalty and looks abandoned to a visitor.
- **No named projects** except one mention. Barlow names every build (ZARMA, Kokomo, Bon Sol, Aruma). Grimmond names every build (Jefferson Lane, Lila, Tres, Monaco). This is the single biggest positioning lever available.
- **No text overlays, no design-story language, no material specifics.** Barlow calls out "Taj Mahal stone with soft rust-toned veining paired with Polytec Boston Oak cabinetry." Coast Life says "gear on site." Same industry, opposite positioning.
- **Hashtag set is thin and repetitive.** #CoastLifeConstructions #GoldCoastBuilder #OnSite / #OnTheTools rotates every post. No project hashtags, no material hashtags, no design-community hashtags.
- **No pinned posts strategy visible** — first-time visitors get whatever the algorithm shows.

Benchmark 1 — @barlowbuilding (the aspirational target)

Positioning: Architecture-led custom builder. "Building in service of the design."

Numbers

Metric	Value
Recent post engagement	41 / 136 / 79 / 113 likes
Comment density	2–6 comments per post
Cadence (June 2026)	4 posts in 10 days
Format mix	~83% carousels, occasional Reels

What Barlow does that Coast Life doesn't

1. **Every project has a name.** ZARMA, Kokomo, Bon Sol, Aruma, Cali Residence, Namiya. Each name becomes a mini-brand. Followers start asking "which project is this?" — that's the engagement flywheel.
2. **Design-story captions.** Real example, verbatim:

> "This kitchen is a celebration of natural warmth and texture, flooded with light and anchored by **Taj Mahal stone with soft rust-toned veining**, paired seamlessly with rich hardwood timber floors and **Polytec Boston Oak cabinetry**."

That caption is a masterclass. It names the materials (which suppliers reshare), it tells a design story (which homeowners save), and it ends with a phone number CTA (which converts).

3. **They tag their trade partners in every post.** @polytec, @upinstone_goldcoast, @towerdoors, @fuller_electrical. Every tag = a reshare opportunity. Coast Life doesn't do this.
4. **Text overlay design language.** "BUILDING IN SERVICE OF THE DESIGN." — clean sans-serif, centre frame, minimal. Editorial, not tradie.
5. **Warm neutral grade, consistent.** Honey oak, travertine, cream, charcoal accents. The grid looks like one book, not one hundred separate site visits.
6. **They post the *design process*, not just the build process.** Post #3 was people studying drawings on a wall — captioned "Translating intent into reality." That's a totally different narrative from "boys getting straight into it."
7. **Sub-brand ecosystem.** @by_barlow and @namiya_bybarlow are project/product sub-accounts. Sophisticated. Not needed at Coast Life's stage but worth knowing exists.

Benchmark 2 — @grimmondau (the ceiling)

Positioning: Premium residential construction & development. Luxury homes for clients who demand the best.

Numbers

Metric	Value
Followers	8,313
Following	1,305
Posts	478
Engagement rate	1.03% (avg 78.5 likes / 7.13 comments)

What Grimmond does that Coast Life doesn't

1. **Brand ecosystem beyond Instagram.** They run a **YouTube series called REBIRTH** documenting builds long-form. That's the top of the funnel Instagram feeds into. Coast Life has no long-form content anchor yet — this is a future move.
2. **All-caps single-word brand mark.** "GRIMMOND." Editorial, confident. Barlow does the same ("BARLOW."). Both look like architecture firms, not builders. Coast Life's handle (@coast_life_constructions_qld) is long and location-tagged — reads more like a small business than a brand.
3. **Website is full-bleed black, minimal.** Signals premium. Coast Life's Houzz-tier online presence needs an upgrade in parallel with the IG rebuild.
4. **Named projects with dedicated URLs.** Jefferson Lane, Lila, Tres, Monaco — each project has its own page. This is what happens when the named-project discipline runs for 3+ years. Compounds massively.
5. **Warm neutral, moody editorial grade.** Slightly more contrast than Barlow, slightly less than a fashion account. High-end residential architectural photography.
6. **They post less often but with more weight.** Social Blade shows 0 posts in the last 14 days. That's fine — the ecosystem is doing the work. Coast Life isn't at that stage yet and needs consistent cadence for another 12–18 months minimum.

Positioning gap — visualised

Dimension	Coast Life today	Barlow (near-term target)	Grimmond (long-term ceiling)
Handle	@coast_life_constructions_qld	@barlowbuilding	@grimmondau
Brand mark	Long, location-tagged	"BARLOW." single word	"GRIMMOND." single word
Captions	Interchangeable, tradie-generic	Design-story, material-named	Minimal, editorial
Projects named	1 mention ("Ladds Ridge")	Every project	Every project
Trade tags	None visible	8–10 per post	5+ per post
Text overlays	None	Clean editorial sans-serif	Minimal or none
Grade	Natural / mixed	Warm neutral, consistent	Warm moody, consistent

Dimension	Coast Life today	Barlow (near-term target)	Grimmond (long-term ceiling)
Finished-build shots	Missing	Core content	Core content
BTS content	100%	~25%	~15%
Design-process content	0%	~20%	~20%
Engagement per post	12–34 likes	41–136 likes	~78 avg
Commenter type	Roofers, tradies	Suppliers, designers, lifestyle	Design community
Named CTA	None	Phone number	Website / project pages
Long-form anchor	None	Website / project pages	YouTube REBIRTH series

The Coast Life move — three positioning shifts

Shift 1: Name every project going forward

Immediate. No exceptions. Every build gets a name — the suburb, the client's chosen name, or a Coast Life codename. Use it in every post, every hashtag, every story. Retroactively name the last 3 finished builds and reintroduce them.

Shift 2: Rebalance the pillar mix

Move from **100% BTS** to **40% finished builds / 25% BTS / 20% design-process / 15% people.** Finished builds are the missing pillar and the one that drives homeowner enquiries.

Shift 3: Caption voice upgrade

Ban the current caption patterns ("long days", "on the tools", "boys getting into it"). Replace with the design-story, material-specific voice from Barlow — but keep the Coast Life plainspoken Aussie identity so it doesn't feel imported. New voice rules are in the rebuilt `brand_voice.md`.

What this audit does NOT recommend

- **Don't kill the BTS content entirely.** The trade authenticity is a real asset — it's just currently the only thing on the account. Reduce to 25%, not zero.
- **Don't try to become Grimmond overnight.** Grimmond is 8,300 followers and 478 posts of compounded work. The 12-month target is Barlow — architecture-led, named projects, editorial voice.
- **Don't rebrand the handle mid-flight.** The handle is fine. What needs to change is the content on it.
- **Don't spend money on ads until pillars are rebalanced.** Ads amplify whatever's on the account. Amplifying the current mix would attract more roofers, not more homeowners.

What we do next (in order)

1. **Fill in the confirmed proof claims** in `brand_voice.md` (years operating, homes completed, HIA/MBA status, warranty).
2. **Retroactively name the last 3 finished builds.** These become the first three named-project reveals over the coming month.
3. **Produce the 3 pinned posts** from `pinned_posts.md` — Signature Build Reel, Meet Coast Life, How We Actually Build carousel.
4. **Run the rebuilt weekly cadence** from `strategy_guide.md`: 40% finished builds / 25% BTS / 20% educational / 15% people.
5. **Tag every trade partner in every post** starting immediately. This is a free growth lever.
6. **90-day review** — re-audit against Barlow benchmarks. Target: 50+ likes per post, mixed commenter base including at least one designer or homeowner per week.